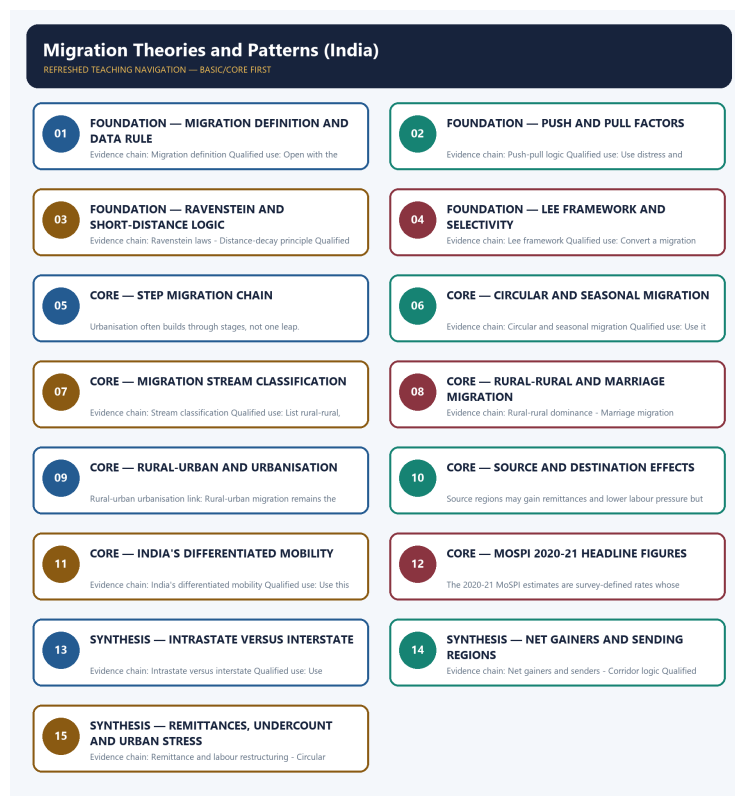


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Migration Theories and Patterns (India) - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Migration Theories and Patterns (India) - Learner-v2

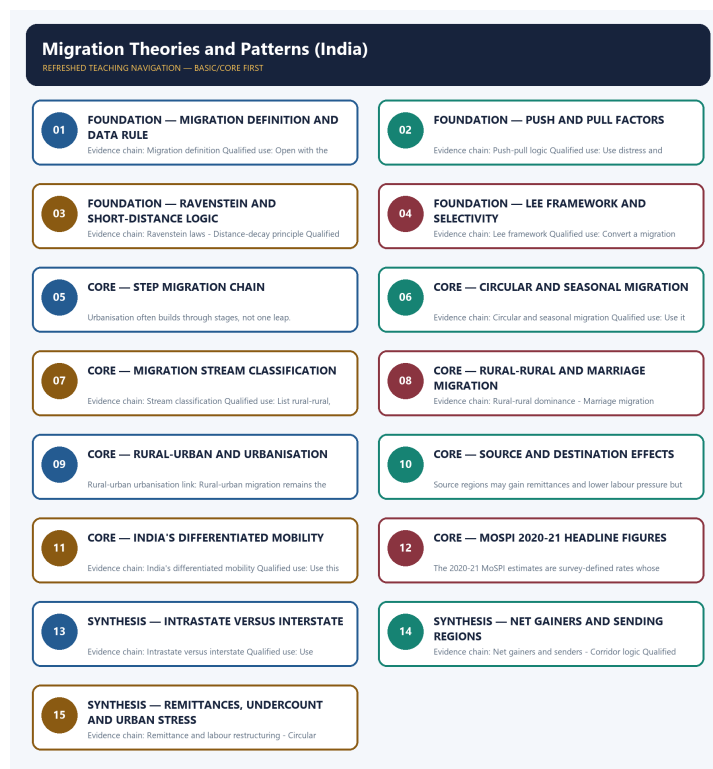
Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-01. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-01.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The three required local Geography books were inspected as supplementary OCR/searchable evidence. No unsupported page precision, volatile figure or quotation was imported.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Verified routing for this rebuild comes from the owner files: the 2024 GS-I demand on why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns is supported directly inside the Basic owner, while the 2018 indentured-labour demand remains cross-cutting and is not falsely recast as a direct solved PYQ here.
- **Live-link boundary:** MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21 remains the latest official all-India survey-style anchor at this cutoff. Census 2027 is only a scheduled baseline refresh, so no new migration result is invented or implied here.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - MIGRATION DEFINITION AND DATA RULE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Migration definition: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Migration definition Qualified use: Open with the residence concept before using census or survey migration numbers.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Migration definition: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Migration definition**
- **data rule**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Migration**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Migration definition, connect data rule with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MIGRATION DEFINITION AND DATA RULE

01. Migration definition

BOUNDARY -> Definition by usual residence matters before any analysis begins.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Migration definition:** Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Definition by usual residence matters before any analysis begins.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Migration definition and data rule.
- **Mains:** Open with the residence concept before using census or survey migration numbers.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Migration definition
- **Qualified use:** Open with the residence concept before using census or survey migration numbers.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - MIGRATION DEFINITION AND DATA RULE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Migration definition and data rule

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Migration definition • data rule • Evidence chain • Qualified use •

Migration

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Migration definition Qualified use: Open with the residence concept before using census or survey migration numbers.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that open with the residence concept before using census or survey migration numbers.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: open with the residence concept before using census or survey migration numbers.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Migration definition: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - PUSH AND PULL FACTORS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Push-pull logic: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Push-pull logic Qualified use: Use distress and opportunity in one causal frame.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Push-pull logic: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Push**
- **pull factors**
- **Push-pull logic**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Push, connect pull factors with Push-pull logic to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PUSH AND PULL FACTORS

01. Push-pull logic

BOUNDARY -> Push and pull operate together, not in isolation.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Push-pull logic:** Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Push and pull operate together, not in isolation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Push and pull factors.
- **Mains:** Use distress and opportunity in one causal frame.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Push-pull logic
- **Qualified use:** Use distress and opportunity in one causal frame.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - PUSH AND PULL FACTORS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Push and pull factors

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Push • pull factors • Push-pull logic • Evidence chain • Qualified use

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Push-pull logic Qualified use: Use distress and opportunity in one causal frame.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Use distress and opportunity in one causal frame.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Push-pull logic: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - RAVENSTEIN AND SHORT-DISTANCE LOGIC

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Ravenstein is a heuristic, not an iron law.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Ravenstein laws - Distance-decay principle Qualified use: Explain distance-decay, short moves and counter-streams together.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Ravenstein laws - Distance-decay principle Qualified use: Explain distance-decay, short moves and counter-streams together.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Ravenstein**

- **short-distance logic**
- **Ravenstein laws**
- **Distance-decay principle**
- **Evidence chain**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Ravenstein, connect short-distance logic with Ravenstein laws to explain the mechanism, and use Distance-decay principle for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

RAVENSTEIN AND SHORT-DISTANCE LOGIC

01. Ravenstein laws

|

v

02. Distance-decay principle

BOUNDARY -> Ravenstein is a heuristic, not an iron law.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Ravenstein laws:** Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.
- **Distance-decay principle:** Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Ravenstein is a heuristic, not an iron law.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Ravenstein and short-distance logic.
- **Mains:** Explain distance-decay, short moves and counter-streams together.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Ravenstein laws -> Distance-decay principle
- **Qualified use:** Explain distance-decay, short moves and counter-streams together.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - RAVENSTEIN AND SHORT-DISTANCE LOGIC

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Ravenstein and short-distance logic

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Ravenstein • short-distance logic • Ravenstein laws • Distance-decay principle • Evidence chain

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mains: Explain distance-decay, short moves and counter-streams together.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Ravenstein is a heuristic, not an iron law.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: ravenstein is a heuristic, not an iron law.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Ravenstein laws - Distance-decay principle Qualified use: Explain distance-decay, short moves and counter-streams together.

SESSION 4 - FOUNDATION - LEE FRAMEWORK AND SELECTIVITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Lee framework: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Lee framework Qualified use: Convert a migration answer into a diagram with origin, destination and obstacles.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Lee framework: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Lee framework
- selectivity
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Lee's

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Lee framework, connect selectivity with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

LEE FRAMEWORK AND SELECTIVITY

01. Lee framework

BOUNDARY -> Do not forget intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Lee framework:** Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not forget intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Lee framework and selectivity.
- **Mains:** Convert a migration answer into a diagram with origin, destination and obstacles.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Lee framework
- **Qualified use:** Convert a migration answer into a diagram with origin, destination and obstacles.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - LEE FRAMEWORK AND SELECTIVITY

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Lee framework and selectivity
|
v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Lee framework · selectivity · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Lee's
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Lee framework Qualified use: Convert a migration answer into a diagram with origin, destination and obstacles.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not forget intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not forget intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Lee framework: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

SESSION 5 - CORE - STEP MIGRATION CHAIN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Step migration chain Qualified use: Use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

Technical definition: Urbanisation often builds through stages, not one leap.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Step migration chain Qualified use: Use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Step migration chain
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Urbanisation
- Step
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Step migration chain; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Urbanisation to explain the mechanism, and use Step for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STEP MIGRATION CHAIN

01. Step migration chain

BOUNDARY -> Urbanisation often builds through stages, not one leap.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Step migration chain:** Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Urbanisation often builds through stages, not one leap.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Step migration chain.
- **Mains:** Use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Step migration chain
- **Qualified use:** Use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - STEP MIGRATION CHAIN

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Step migration chain

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Step migration chain • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Urbanisation • Step • Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Urbanisation often builds through stages, not one leap.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Step migration chain Qualified use: Use village-town-city-metropolis as the classic sequence.

SESSION 6 - CORE - CIRCULAR AND SEASONAL MIGRATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Circular and seasonal migration: Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Circular and seasonal migration Qualified use: Use it to explain precarity, construction labour and welfare-portability issues.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Circular and seasonal migration Qualified use: Use it to explain precarity, construction labour and welfare-portability issues.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Circular**
- **seasonal migration**
- **Circular and seasonal migration**

- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Circular migration**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Circular; define seasonal migration, connect Circular and seasonal migration with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CIRCULAR AND SEASONAL MIGRATION

01. Circular and seasonal migration

BOUNDARY -> Circular migration is mobility without final permanent settlement.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Circular and seasonal migration:** Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Circular migration is mobility without final permanent settlement.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Circular and seasonal migration.
- **Mains:** Use it to explain precarity, construction labour and welfare-portability issues.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Circular and seasonal migration
- **Qualified use:** Use it to explain precarity, construction labour and welfare-portability issues.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CIRCULAR AND SEASONAL MIGRATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Circular and seasonal migration

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Circular · seasonal migration · Circular and seasonal migration · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Circular migration

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Circular and seasonal migration: Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Circular migration is mobility without final permanent settlement.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use it to explain precarity, construction labour and welfare-portability issues.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Circular and seasonal migration Qualified use: Use it to explain precarity, construction labour and welfare-portability issues.

SESSION 7 - CORE - MIGRATION STREAM CLASSIFICATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Stream classification: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Stream classification Qualified use: List rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural cleanly.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Stream classification: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Migration stream classification
- Stream classification
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Migration
- Stream

How to use them: Frame the answer through Migration stream classification; define Stream classification, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Migration for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MIGRATION STREAM CLASSIFICATION

01. Stream classification

BOUNDARY -> Separate administrative distance from rural-urban character.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Stream classification:** Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Separate administrative distance from rural-urban character.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Migration stream classification.
- **Mains:** List rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural cleanly.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Stream classification
- **Qualified use:** List rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural cleanly.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - MIGRATION STREAM CLASSIFICATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Migration stream classification

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Migration stream classification · Stream classification · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Migration · Stream

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Stream classification Qualified use: List rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural cleanly.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural...

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Stream classification: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

SESSION 8 - CORE - RURAL-RURAL AND MARRIAGE MIGRATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Rural-rural dominance: Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Rural-rural dominance - Marriage migration dominance Qualified use: Explain why marriage keeps rural-rural migration large in India.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Rural-rural dominance - Marriage migration dominance Qualified use: Explain why marriage keeps rural-rural migration large in India.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Rural-rural
- marriage migration
- Rural-rural dominance
- Marriage migration dominance
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

How to use them: Frame the answer through Rural-rural; define marriage migration, connect Rural-rural dominance with Marriage migration dominance to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

RURAL-RURAL AND MARRIAGE MIGRATION

01. Rural-rural dominance

|
v

02. Marriage migration dominance

BOUNDARY -> Recorded migration totals are not identical to labour migration totals.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Rural-rural dominance:** Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.
- **Marriage migration dominance:** Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Recorded migration totals are not identical to labour migration totals.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Rural-rural and marriage migration.
- **Mains:** Explain why marriage keeps rural-rural migration large in India.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Rural-rural dominance -> Marriage migration dominance
- **Qualified use:** Explain why marriage keeps rural-rural migration large in India.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - RURAL-RURAL AND MARRIAGE MIGRATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Rural-rural and marriage migration

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Rural-rural • marriage migration • Rural-rural dominance • Marriage migration dominance • Evidence chain • Qualified use

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Rural-rural dominance: Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Recorded migration totals are not identical to labour migration totals.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: explain why marriage keeps rural-rural migration large in India.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Rural-rural dominance - Marriage migration dominance
Qualified use: Explain why marriage keeps rural-rural migration large in India.

SESSION 9 - CORE - RURAL-URBAN AND URBANISATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Rural-urban urbanisation link Qualified use: Show why rural-urban flow remains the urban-growth stream.

Technical definition: Rural-urban urbanisation link: Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Rural-urban urbanisation link Qualified use: Show why rural-urban flow remains the urban-growth stream.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Rural-urban
- urbanisation
- Rural-urban urbanisation link
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Rural-urban; define urbanisation, connect Rural-urban urbanisation link with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

RURAL-URBAN AND URBANISATION

01. Rural-urban urbanisation link

BOUNDARY -> Do not let marriage migration erase labour migration.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Rural-urban urbanisation link:** Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not let marriage migration erase labour migration.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Rural-urban and urbanisation.
- **Mains:** Show why rural-urban flow remains the urban-growth stream.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Rural-urban urbanisation link
- **Qualified use:** Show why rural-urban flow remains the urban-growth stream.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - RURAL-URBAN AND URBANISATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Rural-urban and urbanisation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Rural-urban · urbanisation · Rural-urban urbanisation link · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Rural-urban urbanisation link: Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not let marriage migration erase labour migration.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: show why rural-urban flow remains the urban-growth stream.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Rural-urban urbanisation link Qualified use: Show why rural-urban flow remains the urban-growth stream.

SESSION 10 - CORE - SOURCE AND DESTINATION EFFECTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Migration changes both the place people leave and the place where they settle, creating gains and costs on each side.

Technical definition: Source regions may gain remittances and lower labour pressure but lose selected skills or workers, while destinations gain labour and demand but face differentiated housing, service and integration pressures.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Migration redistributes people, income, skills and service burdens between linked source and destination regions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- source region
- destination region
- remittances
- labour supply
- urban services
- social costs

How to use them: Compare source-region remittances and labour supply with destination-region jobs and urban services; then add skill loss, congestion, housing and social-integration qualifications.

VISUAL FIRST

SOURCE AND DESTINATION EFFECTS

01. Source-destination effects

BOUNDARY -> One-sided answers on cities or villages alone stay incomplete.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Source-destination effects:** Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- One-sided answers on cities or villages alone stay incomplete.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Source and destination effects.
- **Mains:** Balance remittances, labour gains, congestion and slum pressure together.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Source-destination effects
- **Qualified use:** Balance remittances, labour gains, congestion and slum pressure together.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SOURCE AND DESTINATION EFFECTS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Source and destination effects

|
v

EXACT TERMS: source region · destination region · remittances · labour supply · urban services · social costs

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Source-destination effects Qualified use: Balance remittances, labour gains, congestion and slum pressure together.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that balance remittances, labour gains, congestion and slum pressure together.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: balance remittances, labour gains, congestion and slum pressure together.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Migration redistributes people, income, skills and service burdens between linked source and destination regions.

SESSION 11 - CORE - INDIA'S DIFFERENTIATED MOBILITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: India's differentiated mobility: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: India's differentiated mobility Qualified use: Use this as the transition sentence from theory to India.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

India's differentiated mobility: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- India's differentiated mobility
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Khullar
- India
- Western

How to use them: Frame the answer through India's differentiated mobility; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Khullar to explain the mechanism, and use India for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA'S DIFFERENTIATED MOBILITY

01. India's differentiated mobility

BOUNDARY -> India is less mobile than some Western societies but highly varied internally.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **India's differentiated mobility:** Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- India is less mobile than some Western societies but highly varied internally.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to India's differentiated mobility.
- **Mains:** Use this as the transition sentence from theory to India.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** India's differentiated mobility
- **Qualified use:** Use this as the transition sentence from theory to India.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - INDIA'S DIFFERENTIATED MOBILITY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - India's differentiated mobility

|

v

EXACT TERMS: India's differentiated mobility · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Khullar · India · Western

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: India's differentiated mobility Qualified use: Use this as the transition sentence from theory to India.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: India is less mobile than some Western societies but highly varied internally.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use this as the transition sentence from theory to India.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: India's differentiated mobility: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

SESSION 12 - CORE - MOSPI 2020-21 HEADLINE FIGURES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: MoSPI migration figures must be quoted together with their survey year, population base and rural-urban categories.

Technical definition: The 2020-21 MoSPI estimates are survey-defined rates whose all-India, rural and urban values must retain the report period, denominator and migration definition before comparison.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A migration statistic is usable evidence only when agency, survey period, denominator and category travel with the number.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- MoSPI
- 2020-21
- all-India migration rate
- rural migration rate
- urban migration rate
- survey definition

How to use them: Name MoSPI and 2020-21, state the all-India migration rate, compare rural and urban migration rates on the same denominator, then disclose the survey definition and avoid projecting the figures to another year.

VISUAL FIRST

MOSPI 2020-21 HEADLINE FIGURES

01. MoSPI all-India migration rate

|

v

02. Rural and urban migration rates

BOUNDARY -> Survey figures need the source and year label.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **MoSPI all-India migration rate:** MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.
- **Rural and urban migration rates:** The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Survey figures need the source and year label.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to MoSPI 2020-21 headline figures.
- **Mains:** Quote all-India, rural and urban migration rates together.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** MoSPI all-India migration rate -> Rural and urban migration rates
- **Qualified use:** Quote all-India, rural and urban migration rates together.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - MOSPI 2020-21 HEADLINE FIGURES

START / CONCEPT: CORE - MoSPI 2020-21 headline figures

|
v

EXACT TERMS: MoSPI · 2020-21 · all-India migration rate · rural migration rate · urban migration rate · survey definition

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: MoSPI all-India migration rate - Rural and urban migration rates Qualified use: Quote all-India, rural and urban migration rates together.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that moSPI all-India migration rate - Rural and urban migration rates Qualified use.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: moSPI all-India migration rate - Rural and urban migration rates Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A migration statistic is usable evidence only when agency, survey period, denominator and category travel with the number.

SESSION 13 - SYNTHESIS - INTRASTATE VERSUS INTERSTATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Interstate migration is not the dominant share in India.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Intrastate versus interstate Qualified use: Use intrastate majority as the safest prelims firewall.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Intrastate versus interstate: In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- SYNTHESIS
- Intrastate versus interstate
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- In MoSPI
- 2020-21

How to use them: Frame the answer through SYNTHESIS; define Intrastate versus interstate, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use In MoSPI for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

INTRASTATE VERSUS INTERSTATE

01. Intrastate versus interstate

BOUNDARY -> Interstate migration is not the dominant share in India.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Intrastate versus interstate:** In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Interstate migration is not the dominant share in India.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Intrastate versus interstate.
- **Mains:** Use intrastate majority as the safest prelims firewall.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Intrastate versus interstate
- **Qualified use:** Use intrastate majority as the safest prelims firewall.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SYNTHESIS - INTRASTATE VERSUS INTERSTATE

START / CONCEPT: SYNTHESIS - Intrastate versus interstate

|

v

EXACT TERMS: SYNTHESIS • Intrastate versus interstate • Evidence chain • Qualified use • In MoSPI • 2020-21

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Intrastate versus interstate Qualified use: Use intrastate majority as the safest prelims firewall.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Interstate migration is not the dominant share in India.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use intrastate majority as the safest prelims firewall.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Intrastate versus interstate: In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

SESSION 14 - SYNTHESIS - NET GAINERS AND SENDING REGIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Net gainers and senders: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Net gainers and senders - Corridor logic Qualified use: Map agrarian sending regions against industrial and service corridors.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Net gainers and senders: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- SYNTHESIS

- Net gainers
- sending regions
- Net gainers and senders
- Corridor logic
- Evidence chain

How to use them: Frame the answer through SYNTHESIS; define Net gainers, connect sending regions with Net gainers and senders to explain the mechanism, and use Corridor logic for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NET GAINERS AND SENDING REGIONS

01. Net gainers and senders

|

v

02. Corridor logic

BOUNDARY -> Do not describe migration as random movement across the map.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Net gainers and senders:** Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.
- **Corridor logic:** India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe migration as random movement across the map.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Net gainers and sending regions.
- **Mains:** Map agrarian sending regions against industrial and service corridors.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Net gainers and senders -> Corridor logic
- **Qualified use:** Map agrarian sending regions against industrial and service corridors.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SYNTHESIS - NET GAINERS AND SENDING REGIONS

START / CONCEPT: SYNTHESIS - Net gainers and sending regions

|

v

EXACT TERMS: SYNTHESIS · Net gainers · sending regions · Net gainers and senders · Corridor logic · Evidence chain

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Net gainers and senders - Corridor logic Qualified use: Map agrarian sending regions against industrial and service corridors.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not describe migration as random movement across the map.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Net gainers and senders: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

SESSION 15 - SYNTHESIS - REMITTANCES, UNDERCOUNT AND URBAN STRESS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Circular undercount and urban stress: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Remittance and labour restructuring - Circular undercount and urban stress
Qualified use: Conclude with remittances, undercount and welfare-portability pressure.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Circular undercount and urban stress: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **SYNTHESIS**
- **Remittances**
- **undercount**
- **urban stress**
- **Remittance and labour restructuring**
- **Circular undercount and urban stress**

How to use them: Frame the answer through SYNTHESIS; define Remittances, connect undercount with urban stress to explain the mechanism, and use Remittance and labour restructuring for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

REMITTANCES, UNDERCOUNT AND URBAN STRESS

01. Remittance and labour restructuring

|
v

02. Circular undercount and urban stress

BOUNDARY -> Migration supports households but also exposes data and service-delivery gaps.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- **Remittance and labour restructuring:** Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment.
- **Circular undercount and urban stress:** Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Migration supports households but also exposes data and service-delivery gaps.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Separate the agent, landform, location, status and scale attached to Remittances, undercount and urban stress.
- **Mains:** Conclude with remittances, undercount and welfare-portability pressure.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Remittance and labour restructuring -> Circular undercount and urban stress
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with remittances, undercount and welfare-portability pressure.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Geography · **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation + standard) · **GS Paper:** GS-I **Grounded in:** Majid Husain, *Indian & World Geography* + G.C. Leong for physical-resource context + verified MoSPI current anchor. **FACT:** = from source book or official source · **ANALYSIS:** = inference / standard synthesis · **CURRENT:** = current affairs.
Companion: advanced/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India.md.

1. What migration means in geography

FACT: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary; it may be internal or international, and official datasets may use place of birth or last usual residence. Majid Husain explains the logic through **push factors** from the origin and **pull factors** at the destination.

Basic term	Meaning
FACT: Migration	Change of usual residence; may be internal or international
FACT: Immigration	Movement into a country
FACT: Emigration	Movement out of a country
FACT: Push factors	Distress, conflict, disaster, job loss, social pressure
FACT: Pull factors	Jobs, wages, safety, education, amenities
FACT: Refugee	Person meeting the applicable refugee-law definition; not every forced migrant has the same legal status

2. Classical theories you should know

ANALYSIS: Migration models are analytical tools, not iron laws; motives, obstacles and selectivity interact. The models below are therefore best used as analytical tools, not iron laws.

Theory / idea	Core proposition	UPSC utility
ANALYSIS: Ravenstein's laws	Most migrants move short distances; migration often occurs step by step; each major stream creates a counter-stream	Good for explaining rural-urban chains
ANALYSIS: Lee's framework	Migration reflects push factors, pull factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity	Useful in diagram-based Mains answers
ANALYSIS: Distance-decay idea	Volume of migration usually falls with distance unless opportunities are exceptional	Explains local dominance of short-range migration
ANALYSIS: Step migration	Village -> small town -> city -> metropolis sequence	Useful in urbanisation questions
ANALYSIS: Circular / seasonal migration	Repeated movement without final permanent shift	Important for labour geography

3. Types and streams of migration

FACT: Official migration measurement commonly compares place of birth or last usual residence with place of enumeration. **FACT:** He also distinguishes major internal streams by rural and urban origin-destination combinations.

Type	Example	Static note
FACT: Internal migration	Movement within a country	Intra-district, inter-district, interstate

Type	Example	Static note
FACT: International migration	Country-to-country movement	Immigration and emigration
FACT: Rural-to-rural	Marriage or farm-labour movement	Often the largest stream in traditional societies
FACT: Rural-to-urban	Labour, education, services	Strongly linked to urbanisation
FACT: Urban-to-urban	Professional and business mobility	Hierarchical city networks
FACT: Urban-to-rural	Retirement, return migration, peri-urban spillover	Smaller but conceptually important

4. Effects on source and destination regions

FACT: Migration changes origin areas, destination areas and migrants themselves. FACT: He also links migration with changing sex structure, labour availability, remittances, slums and pressure on infrastructure.

Effect	Source area	Destination area
FACT: Population size	May lose population	Gains population
FACT: Age-sex structure	Often loses young adults	Often gains young working-age groups
FACT: Economy	Remittances may support households	Labour supply rises
FACT: Society	New ideas may travel back	Cultural mixing rises
FACT: Environment	Pressure may reduce locally	Urban congestion, pollution and slums may rise

5. World patterns and why they differ

- ANALYSIS: Labour migration is often strongest along opportunity corridors: mines, industrial belts, ports, construction zones and service hubs.
- ANALYSIS: Forced migration follows war, persecution, border change and ecological stress.
- ANALYSIS: Gender patterns differ: some streams are male-dominated work migration, while others are female-dominated marriage migration.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore migration is never “only economic”; culture, kinship, law, transport and state policy also matter.

6. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) and UPSC traps

- FACT: Migration is a component of population change, along with fertility and mortality.
- FACT: Push and pull can operate together; the same factor may push one group and attract another.
- FACT: Internal migration can be classified both by administrative distance and by rural-urban character.
- FACT: Migration can improve incomes while worsening congestion in destination regions.
- FACT: Remittance is a major link between migration and rural development.
- WRONG: Migration always reduces population pressure -> It may shift pressure from one region to another.
- WRONG: All migration is long-distance -> Short-distance and step migration are often more common.
- WRONG: Refugees and voluntary emigrants are the same -> Forced and voluntary movements differ legally and analytically.

7. Exam linkage

- ANALYSIS: Recurring UPSC theme: migration as the bridge between population geography and urbanisation.
- ANALYSIS: Prelims often tests stream classification: rural-rural versus rural-urban versus urban-urban.
- ANALYSIS: Mains may ask whether migration is a safety valve, a distress signal or both.

8. CURRENT: Current link

CA Anchor - MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21

CURRENT: **News trigger:** MoSPI released *Migration in India 2020-21* in June 2022 using the PLFS framework, again highlighting that marriage and work remain the dominant reasons behind internal migration.

Current fact	Static concept
FACT: Migration must be measured carefully by residence concept	Definition matters in data interpretation
FACT: Work and marriage remain central migration drivers	Push-pull and gender-selective migration
FACT: Temporary movement surged during the pandemic period	Circular and distress migration are analytically important

9. Mains angles

- Explain migration using push-pull, intervening obstacles and selectivity.
- Show how migration can simultaneously reduce pressure in one region and create stress in another.

10. Probable Questions

Prelims-style concept prompt

- ANALYSIS: Which of the following statements about migration theory is/are correct? (1) Ravenstein's laws suggest migration often occurs step by step. (2) Lee's framework includes push factors, pull factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. **Answer:** Both statements are correct, because this file presents step migration under Ravenstein's logic and describes Lee's framework through exactly these four elements.

Probable Mains questions (10-15 marks)

- ANALYSIS: Discuss how push factors, pull factors and intervening obstacles together shape internal migration streams. (15 marks)
- ANALYSIS: Examine how migration can simultaneously reduce pressure in one region and create congestion, slums and infrastructure stress in another. (10 marks)

11. Study link

Geography -> Human Geography -> Migration Geography -> Human Geography -> Migration Streams & Consequences

12. Migration models, India's streams and the policy question

Why this section exists: the file named Ravenstein and Lee but omitted the **predictive and economic models**, carried **no Indian migration corridors or streams**, and treated remittances and distress migration as passing mentions. Those are the elements a 10- or 15-mark answer needs.

12.1 The model set, arranged by what each explains

Model	Core proposition	What it explains well	Where it fails
ANALYSIS: Ravenstein's laws	Most migration is short-distance and proceeds by steps toward centres of commerce and industry; each stream generates a counter-stream; women predominate in short-distance movement	Distance decay, step migration, counter-streams - still empirically robust	Derived from one nineteenth-century national context; treats migration as largely economic
ANALYSIS: Lee's push-pull framework	Migration results from factors at origin, factors at destination, intervening obstacles , and personal factors	Adds obstacles and perception; explains why identical differentials produce different flows	Descriptive rather than predictive; the categories are not measurable
ANALYSIS: Gravity model	Flow between two places rises with their populations and falls with the distance between them	Gives a usable quantitative first approximation of flow volume	Ignores culture, networks, policy and information; distance is a poor proxy for real cost
ANALYSIS: Stouffer's intervening opportunities	Migration to a destination is proportional to the opportunities there and inversely proportional to the opportunities encountered along the way	Explains why a nearer, smaller city can capture migrants bound for a larger one	Requires opportunity to be quantifiable
ANALYSIS: Todaro / Harris-Todaro	Migrants respond to expected urban income - the urban wage discounted by the probability of getting a job - not to the observed wage	Explains why rural-urban migration continues despite visible urban unemployment; explains informal-sector absorption	Assumes better information than migrants have; understates non-economic motives
ANALYSIS: Zelinsky's mobility transition	Mobility type changes systematically with the stage of the demographic transition - from rural colonisation to rural-urban to inter-urban and circular movement	Links migration to demography; explains why mobility patterns change over development	Broad-brush and stage-based, with the same limitations as the transition model
ANALYSIS: Network / chain migration	Earlier migrants lower the cost and risk for later ones from the same origin	Explains corridor persistence - why specific source districts feed specific destinations for decades	Under-explains the initial flow

- ANALYSIS: **The most useful pairing in an answer:** Todaro explains *why* people move despite urban unemployment; network theory explains *why they move to that particular city*. Neither alone explains observed Indian corridors.

12.2 India's migration geography

Stream	Character	Analytical point
ANALYSIS: Rural-to-rural	Historically the largest internal stream in India, and heavily female because marriage is the dominant recorded reason for female migration	This is why raw migration totals are misleading if read as economic movement
ANALYSIS: Rural-to-urban	The classic economic stream; strongly male-dominated in the work category	The stream that drives urbanisation and informal-sector growth
ANALYSIS: Urban-to-urban	Growing with a maturing urban system	Skilled and inter-metropolitan movement
ANALYSIS: Urban-to-rural	Smallest; return migration on retirement, distress or shock	The 2020 pandemic reversal was a temporary, extreme instance
ANALYSIS: Seasonal and circular	Repeated short-term movement tied to the agricultural calendar and construction cycles	Systematically under-counted by censuses that use a place-of-last-residence definition; this measurement problem is itself an examinable point
ANALYSIS: International - skilled	Professional emigration to advanced economies	Brain drain versus brain circulation and diaspora investment
ANALYSIS: International - contract labour	Semi-skilled and unskilled contract work, notably to West Asia	The principal remittance source for specific southern and eastern source regions

- ANALYSIS: **Direction of internal flow:** the dominant economic movement runs from ****densely populated**, agriculturally dependent, lower-income regions of the north and east **toward the** industrial-urban and irrigated-agricultural regions of the west, north-west and south^{**}. This reflects exactly the regional disparity analysed in 29_Regional-Development-and-Five-Year-Plans.md - migration is disparity made visible.
- ANALYSIS: **Remittances** operate at two scales: internal remittances sustain consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source villages; international remittances have transformed specific source regions' housing, education and land markets. The analytical point is that remittances **raise consumption and reduce poverty reliably, but do not by themselves create local productive employment** - which is why source regions can become remittance-dependent without becoming developed.

12.3 Effects, stated as a balance sheet

	Source region	Destination region
ANALYSIS: Gains	Reduced pressure on land and jobs; remittance inflow; skills and ideas returning; reduced open unemployment	Labour supply for construction, manufacturing and services; demographic rejuvenation; entrepreneurship and cultural diversity
ANALYSIS: Losses	Loss of the young, able and often better-educated; skewed age and sex structure; land left under-cultivated; social costs to families left behind	Pressure on housing, water, sanitation and transport; informal settlement growth; wage competition at the bottom; occasional political backlash
ANALYSIS: The honest verdict	Migration is a rational household risk-diversification strategy , not a symptom of failure - but it redistributes the costs of regional inequality onto migrants themselves	The city gains the labour and externalises the reproduction cost of that labour back to the source region

- ANALYSIS: **Distress migration** is distinguished from opportunity migration by its trigger - crop failure, debt, disaster, conflict or displacement - and by the migrant's weak bargaining position on arrival. **Climate- and disaster-induced displacement** is a growing category, and it does not fit the voluntary-migration models above, because the decision is not a wage comparison.
- ANALYSIS: **The portability problem:** an internal migrant in India can lose practical access to

entitlements tied to place of registration - rations, health services, schooling and voting - and policies attempting portability of benefits address exactly this. Institutional detail belongs to Social - Justice and Governance; the geographic point is that **mobility outruns the territorial design of welfare delivery**.

ANALYSIS: Factual caution: do **not** quote a migrant count, a share of internal migrants, remittance values or corridor volumes from memory. The folder's Census-currency rule applies, and any survey figure must carry its source name and release date.

13. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

13.1 Directive decoding

If the question says	It is really asking for	Do not
"Why do large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns?"	Scale and diversity of the opportunity set, expected-income logic, network effects, and the intervening-opportunity qualification	List urban amenities
"Discuss the effects of migration on source and destination"	The two-column balance sheet with named mechanisms on both sides, then a verdict	Give a one-sided problem list
"Examine distress migration"	The trigger-based definition, the weak-bargaining consequence, and the entitlement-portability problem	Merge it with ordinary economic migration
"Evaluate migration theories"	What each model explains and where it fails, then the combined explanation	Describe each theory in sequence

13.2 Reusable 10-mark spine - "why the largest cities capture the most migrants"

1. **Thesis:** migrants are drawn to the largest cities not by higher observed wages alone but by the **breadth of the opportunity set and the probability of finding some work**, reinforced by pre-existing social networks.
2. **Expected-income mechanism (Todaro):** the migrant compares the urban wage **discounted by the probability of employment** with the rural alternative; large cities offer a higher probability across more sectors, so migration persists despite visible unemployment.
3. **Diversity of the opportunity set:** construction, manufacturing, transport, domestic work, retail and the wider informal economy provide multiple simultaneous entry points, which reduces the risk of arriving and finding nothing.
4. **Network effects:** earlier migrants supply information, initial housing, job contacts and credit, lowering entry cost - which is why corridors persist between specific source districts and specific destination cities.
5. **Agglomeration:** larger cities have higher and more diverse labour demand, better connectivity and better health, education and service access.
6. **Counterpoint and qualification:** Stouffer's intervening opportunities predict that a nearer growing city can intercept the flow, and the emergence of regional urban centres does divert some movement; large-city costs of living, housing and commuting also offset the wage advantage.
7. **Conclusion:** graded - the pull of large cities is a symptom of the **spatial concentration of opportunity**, so it can only be moderated by building genuine opportunity in intermediate towns, not by restricting movement.

13.3 Evidence units available in this file

Claim: migration continues toward cities that already have visible unemployment, so the observed-wage explanation is inadequate. **Evidence:** the expected-income framework holds that migrants weigh the urban wage by the probability of obtaining work, and that a large, diversified informal sector raises that probability. **Significance:** it explains persistent rural-urban movement and the growth of informal employment as a rational response rather than a mistake. **Limitation:** it assumes migrants have reasonably good information about urban conditions, and it under-weights marriage, education, kinship and distress, which drive much observed movement.

Claim: migration corridors are social structures, not merely economic gradients. **Evidence:** specific source districts feed specific destination cities over decades because earlier migrants supply information, housing, credit and job contacts to later ones. **Significance:** it explains corridor persistence, occupational clustering by origin community, and why the same wage differential produces flows along some routes and not others. **Limitation:** network theory explains continuation better than initiation, so the original impetus must still be explained economically or historically.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	5	Why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SYNTHESIS - REMITTANCES, UNDERCOUNT AND URBAN STRESS

START / CONCEPT: SYNTHESIS - Remittances, undercount and urban stress

|

v

EXACT TERMS: SYNTHESIS · Remittances · undercount · urban stress · Remittance and labour restructuring · Circular undercount and urban stress

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Remittance and labour restructuring - Circular undercount and urban stress Qualified use: Conclude with remittances, undercount and welfare-portability pressure.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Remittance and labour restructuring: Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Circular undercount and urban stress: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Migration definition?

A. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. B. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. C. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. D. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.

Answer: A. Explanation: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Migration definition?

A. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. B. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. C. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. D. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.

Answer: B. Explanation: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Migration definition?

A. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. B. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. C. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. D. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

Answer: C. Explanation: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Migration definition?

A. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. B. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. C. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. D. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly explains Push-pull logic?

A. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. B. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. C. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. D. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

Answer: A. Explanation: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Push-pull logic?

A. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. B. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. C. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. D. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

Answer: B. Explanation: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Push-pull logic?

A. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. B. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. C. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. D. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

Answer: C. Explanation: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Push-pull logic?

A. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. B. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. C. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. D. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

Answer: D. Explanation: Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly explains Ravenstein laws?

A. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. B. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. C. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. D. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Ravenstein laws?

A. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. B. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. C. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. D. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Ravenstein laws?

A. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. B. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. C. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. D. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Ravenstein laws?

A. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. B. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. C. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. D. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly explains Lee framework?

A. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. B. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. C. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. D. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

Answer: A. Explanation: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Lee framework?

A. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. B. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. C. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. D. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

Answer: B. Explanation: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Lee framework?

A. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. B. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. C. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. D. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

Answer: C. Explanation: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Lee framework?

A. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. B. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. C. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. D. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

Answer: D. Explanation: Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly explains Distance-decay principle?

A. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. B. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. C. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. D. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

Answer: A. Explanation: Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Distance-decay principle?

A. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. B. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. C. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. D. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

Answer: B. Explanation: Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Distance-decay principle?

A. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. B. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. C. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. D. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Answer: C. Explanation: Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Distance-decay principle?

A. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. B. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. C. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. D. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.

Answer: D. Explanation: Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly explains Step migration chain?

A. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. B. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. C. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. D. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Answer: A. Explanation: Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Step migration chain?

A. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. B. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. C. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. D. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

Answer: B. Explanation: Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Step migration chain?

A. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. B. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. C. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. D. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Answer: C. Explanation: Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Step migration chain?

A. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. B. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. C. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. D. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

Answer: D. Explanation: Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly explains Circular and seasonal migration?

A. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. B. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. C. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. D. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Answer: A. Explanation: Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Circular and seasonal migration?

A. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. B. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. C. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. D. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Answer: B. Explanation: Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Circular and seasonal migration?

A. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. B. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. C. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. D. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.

Answer: C. Explanation: Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Circular and seasonal migration?

A. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. B. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. C. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. D. Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography.

Answer: D. Explanation: Circular or seasonal migration repeats movement without final permanent settlement and is central to labour geography. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly explains Stream classification?

A. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. B. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. C. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. D. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Stream classification?

A. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. B. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. C. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. D. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Stream classification?

A. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. B. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. C. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. D. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Stream classification?

A. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. B. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. C. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. D. Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.

Answer: D. Explanation: Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly explains Rural-rural dominance?

A. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. B. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. C. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. D. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Rural-rural dominance?

A. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. B. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. C. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. D. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Rural-rural dominance?

A. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. B. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. C. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. D. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Rural-rural dominance?

A. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. B. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. C. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. D. Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly explains Rural-urban urbanisation link?

A. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. B. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. C. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. D. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Rural-urban urbanisation link?

A. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. B. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. C. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. D. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Rural-urban urbanisation link?

A. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. B. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. C. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. D. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Rural-urban urbanisation link?

A. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. B. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. C. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. D. Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly explains Source-destination effects?

A. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. B. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. C. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. D. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.

Answer: A. Explanation: Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Source-destination effects?

A. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. B. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. C. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. D. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.

Answer: B. Explanation: Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Source-destination effects?

A. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. B. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. C. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. D. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.

Answer: C. Explanation: Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Source-destination effects?

A. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. B. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. C. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. D. Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly explains India's differentiated mobility?

A. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. B. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. C. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. D. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India's differentiated mobility?

A. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. B. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. C. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. D. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India's differentiated mobility?

A. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. B. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. C. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. D. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India's differentiated mobility?

A. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. B. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. C. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. D. Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western societies but internally very differentiated by marriage, labour and interstate variation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly explains MoSPI all-India migration rate?

A. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. B. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. C. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. D. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.

Answer: A. Explanation: MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of MoSPI all-India migration rate?

A. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. B. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. C. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. D. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

Answer: B. Explanation: MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for MoSPI all-India migration rate?

A. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. B. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. C. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. D. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

Answer: C. Explanation: MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning MoSPI all-India migration rate?

A. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. B. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. C. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. D. MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.

Answer: D. Explanation: MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly explains Rural and urban migration rates?

A. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. B. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. C. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. D. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Rural and urban migration rates?

A. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. B. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. C. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. D. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

Answer: B. Explanation: The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Rural and urban migration rates?

A. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. B. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. C. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. D. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Rural and urban migration rates?

A. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. B. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. C. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. D. The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.

Answer: D. Explanation: The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly explains Intrastate versus interstate?

A. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. B. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. C. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. D. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

Answer: A. Explanation: In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Intrastate versus interstate?

A. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. B. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. C. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. D. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.

Answer: B. Explanation: In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Intrastate versus interstate?

A. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. B. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. C. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. D. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.

Answer: C. Explanation: In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Intrastate versus interstate?

A. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. B. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. C. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. D. In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.

Answer: D. Explanation: In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly explains Marriage migration dominance?

A. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. B. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. C. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. D. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.

Answer: A. Explanation: Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Marriage migration dominance?

A. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. B. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. C. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. D. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Answer: B. Explanation: Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Marriage migration dominance?

A. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. B. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. C. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. D. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Answer: C. Explanation: Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Marriage migration dominance?

A. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. B. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. C. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. D. Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

Answer: D. Explanation: Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly explains Net gainers and senders?

A. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. B. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. C. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. D. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Net gainers and senders?

A. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. B. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. C. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. D. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Net gainers and senders?

A. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. B. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. C. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. D. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Net gainers and senders?

A. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. B. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. C. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. D. Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly explains Corridor logic?

A. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. B. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. C. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. D. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Corridor logic?

A. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. B. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. C. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. D. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Corridor logic?

A. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. B. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. C. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. D. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Corridor logic?

A. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. B. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. C. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. D. India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly explains Remittance and labour restructuring?

A. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. B. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. C. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. D. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Answer: A. Explanation: Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Remittance and labour restructuring?

A. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence. B. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. C. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. D. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

Answer: B. Explanation: Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Remittance and labour restructuring?

A. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. B. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. C. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. D. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

Answer: C. Explanation: Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Remittance and labour restructuring?

A. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. B. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. C. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. D. Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly explains Circular undercount and urban stress?

A. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. B. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. C. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. D. Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.

Answer: A. Explanation: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Circular undercount and urban stress?

A. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams. B. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. C. Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination. D. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

Answer: B. Explanation: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Circular undercount and urban stress?

A. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. B. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. C. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. D. Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.

Answer: C. Explanation: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Circular undercount and urban stress?

A. Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity. B. Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap. C. Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs. D. Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Answer: D. Explanation: Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Verified routing for this rebuild comes from the owner files: the 2024 GS-I demand on why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns is supported directly inside the Basic owner, while the 2018 indentured-labour demand remains cross-cutting and is not falsely recast as a direct solved PYQ here.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	5	Why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	13	Indentured labour export and diaspora cultural identity	Why and Have they · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; colonial labour and migration both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Indentured labour export and diaspora cultural identity

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I

Demand: Why do large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns?

Status: Verified routed demand from the Basic owner and the 2024-2025 PYQ integration block.

Model solution: Large cities attract more migrants because they concentrate diverse job opportunities, transport connections, services and migrant networks, so expected chances of finding some work are higher than in smaller towns. Smaller towns do intercept part of the flow, but big metropolitan nodes still dominate because they combine scale, labour demand and social support networks. The safe qualification is that migration reflects both opportunity and distress, and the attraction of big cities ultimately mirrors the spatial concentration of development.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain migration using push factors, pull factors and intervening obstacles. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Migration decisions arise from origin distress, destination attraction, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity; no one factor explains every stream.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Migration is a change in usual residence across a meaningful geographic or administrative boundary, and datasets may track it by place of birth or last usual residence.
- Migration is commonly explained through push factors at the origin and pull factors at the destination.

- Lee's framework explains migration through origin factors, destination factors, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity.

Qualified conclusion: Migration decisions arise from origin distress, destination attraction, intervening obstacles and personal selectivity; no one factor explains every stream.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why is step migration important in understanding urbanisation? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Step migration shows that urbanisation often grows through a hierarchy of places, not by one jump from village to metropolis.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Ravenstein's laws emphasise short-distance movement, step migration and the creation of counter-streams.
- Migration volume usually falls with distance unless exceptional opportunities or networks offset distance costs.
- Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.

Qualified conclusion: Step migration shows that urbanisation often grows through a hierarchy of places, not by one jump from village to metropolis.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Discuss why India's migration is not one stream but many. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: India's migration geography must separate marriage-led rural-rural movement, labour-led rural-urban mobility, urban-urban professional movement and circular migration.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Migration can be classified as internal or international and, within internal migration, as rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams.
- Rural-rural movement has historically been the largest internal stream in India, especially because marriage migration is large.
- Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.
- Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

Qualified conclusion: India's migration geography must separate marriage-led rural-rural movement, labour-led rural-urban mobility, urban-urban professional movement and circular migration.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the effects of migration on source and destination regions in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Migration redistributes labour and income: remittances support origin households, but cities absorb labour with congestion, informality and service pressure.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Migration changes source and destination regions together through remittances, labour redistribution, sex-structure change, congestion and slum pressure.
- Remittances support consumption, housing, education and debt repayment in source regions, but they do not automatically create local productive employment.
- Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Qualified conclusion: Migration redistributes labour and income: remittances support origin households, but cities absorb labour with congestion, informality and service pressure.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Use the latest official migration snapshot to explain India's internal mobility pattern. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: MoSPI 2020-21 shows that India's migration remains largely intrastate, marriage-heavy in recorded female movement and more urban in incidence, which complicates simplistic labour-migration readings.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- MoSPI's Migration in India 2020-21 gives an all-India migration rate of 28.9 percent.
- The same MoSPI release gives a rural migration rate of 26.5 percent and an urban migration rate of 34.9 percent.
- In MoSPI 2020-21, 87.5 percent of migrants were intrastate and 12.5 percent were interstate.
- Female migrants moving due to marriage formed 86.8 percent of female migrants in the MoSPI 2020-21 snapshot.

Qualified conclusion: MoSPI 2020-21 shows that India's migration remains largely intrastate, marriage-heavy in recorded female movement and more urban in incidence, which complicates simplistic labour-migration readings.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Why do large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns? Analyse with Indian examples. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Large cities concentrate diversified opportunities, networks and labour demand, so they attract migrants despite risk, while smaller centres intercept only part of the flow.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Step migration often proceeds village to small town to city to metropolis rather than by one direct leap.
- Rural-urban migration remains the classic labour stream that fuels urbanisation, construction and informal work.
- Khullar's spatial pattern shows Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab as classic gainers, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central belts are major sending regions.
- India's broad direction of labour mobility runs from lower-income agrarian regions towards industrial, construction and service corridors, making migration both development-seeking and distress-driven.
- Circular migration is undercount-prone in usual-residence measures, while destination cities face rental insecurity, service pressure and informal settlement growth.

Qualified conclusion: Large cities concentrate diversified opportunities, networks and labour demand, so they attract migrants despite risk, while smaller centres intercept only part of the flow.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Geography · **Tier:** Advanced (India-applied) · **GS Paper:** GS-I **Grounded in:** D.R. Khullar, *India: A Comprehensive Geography* + Majid Husain, *Geography of India* + distinct verified MoSPI/Census current anchor.
FACT: = from source book or official source · **ANALYSIS:** = inference / standard synthesis · **CURRENT:** = current affairs. *Companion:* basic/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India.md.

1. Why India is a classic migration geography case

FACT: Khullar describes India as historically less mobile than many Western countries, but internally very differentiated by marriage migration, labour migration, interstate variation and rural-urban flows. **FACT:** He also shows that migration affects not only total numbers but sex ratio, age composition, occupational structure and dependency.

2. Latest official all-India migration snapshot

FACT: MoSPI's *Migration in India 2020-21* remains the latest all-India official survey-style update on the subject.

FACT: It defines migrants by a last usual residence different from the place of enumeration.

Indicator	Verified figure	Source note
FACT: All-India migration rate	28.9%	MoSPI, Migration in India 2020-21

Indicator	Verified figure	Source note
FACT: Rural migration rate	26.5%	Same source
FACT: Urban migration rate	34.9%	Same source
FACT: Share of intrastate migrants	87.5%	Same source
FACT: Share of interstate migrants	12.5%	Same source
FACT: Female migrants moving due to marriage	86.8%	Same source
FACT: Temporary visitors in survey year	0.7% of population	Largely pandemic-related movement in that round

MEMORY: Trap: India's most recent migration numbers come from survey-based official sources, not from a post-2011 census table.

3. Spatial patterns inside India

FACT: Khullar's 2001-era mapping shows several states as net gainers and others as net losers in interstate migration. FACT: Historically, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi/Union Territories, Haryana and Punjab attracted migrants, while Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh-region belts and some eastern states were major sending areas.

- ANALYSIS: Today the broad logic still survives in updated form: industrial, construction, service and metropolitan corridors attract labour from lower-income agrarian regions.
- ANALYSIS: Delhi NCR, the Mumbai-Pune belt, Gujarat's industrial corridor, Punjab-Haryana farm and logistics zones, and Bengaluru-led service regions remain high-attraction spaces.
- ANALYSIS: Migration in India is therefore both **development-seeking** and **distress-driven**.

4. Dominant streams in India

FACT: Khullar clearly identifies rural-rural, rural-urban, urban-urban and urban-rural streams. FACT: He notes that rural-rural movement has long been the biggest stream and that female migrants are especially prominent in it because of marriage migration.

Stream	India-specific reading	Answer cue
FACT: Rural-rural	Marriage, agricultural labour, local mobility	Biggest stream by volume historically
FACT: Rural-urban	Construction, manufacturing, services, informal work	Core urbanisation driver
FACT: Urban-urban	Higher education, white-collar jobs, business transfer	Hierarchical city network
ANALYSIS: Urban-rural	Return migration, peri-urban spillover, retirement	Small but analytically important
ANALYSIS: Circular / seasonal	Brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal labour	Best lens for precarity and portability of welfare

5. Consequences that matter in Indian answers

FACT: Khullar explicitly links migration with remittances, changing sex ratios, labour redistribution, rising dependency in source regions, and overcrowding plus slum pressure in destination cities.

Consequence	India angle
FACT: Remittances	Lifeline for many poor rural households
FACT: Sex composition change	Male-selective labour migration alters source and destination ratios
FACT: Occupational restructuring	Farm households depend on non-farm earnings
FACT: Urban stress	Slums, rental insecurity, water and transport pressure

Consequence	India angle
ANALYSIS: Social change	Greater autonomy for some women, but also care burden and vulnerability

6. Debate: opportunity migration or distress migration?

- ANALYSIS: The same corridor can contain both aspiration and distress: one worker may migrate for skill-led mobility, another for survival.
- ANALYSIS: Rural-urban migration is not automatically a sign of successful structural transformation if urban jobs remain informal and insecure.
- ANALYSIS: Pandemic-era reverse migration made seasonal and circular labour mobility far more visible in policy debate.

7. Institutions and data sources to name

- FACT: **MoSPI / NSS / PLFS-based report**: latest official migration survey snapshot.
- FACT: **Census of India**: long-run migration concepts, place-of-birth and last-residence tables.
- ANALYSIS: For answer quality, always distinguish census concept, survey concept and temporary/circular movement.

8. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) and UPSC traps

- FACT: Most migrants in India are intrastate, not interstate.
- FACT: Marriage is the dominant reason for female migration in official data.
- FACT: Urban migration rate is higher than rural migration rate in the latest MoSPI snapshot.
- FACT: Migration changes population structure, not just population size.
- FACT: Rural-rural movement remains crucial even when public debate focuses only on rural-urban movement.
- WRONG: Interstate migration is the dominant stream in India -> Most migration remains within the same state.
- WRONG: Migration to cities is always permanent -> Seasonal, circular and temporary patterns matter greatly.
- WRONG: Migration only affects destination cities -> It also reshapes rural labour supply, dependency and social relations at origin.

9. Exam linkage

- ANALYSIS: Recurring UPSC theme: migration as a test of regional imbalance and labour-market transformation.
- ANALYSIS: GS-I answers improve when they separate marriage migration, labour migration and distress/circular migration.
- ANALYSIS: Migration also links GS-I with GS-II welfare portability and GS-III urban/informal-economy stress.

10. CURRENT: Current link

CA Anchor - Census 2027 will refresh migration geography, but has no results yet

CURRENT: **News trigger**: Census 2027 is scheduled to collect a new national population baseline. Until its migration tables are released, MoSPI's 2020-21 survey remains the dated survey anchor rather than a substitute for a new census.

Current fact	Static linkage	Use in answer
FACT: Census 2027 scheduled	New migration tables will eventually reset the decennial baseline	Do not invent results
FACT: MoSPI 2020-21 remains dated survey evidence	Census and survey concepts differ	Label source and year
ANALYSIS: Circular migration remains undercount-prone	Usual-residence measures miss some mobility	Use as an evaluative point

ANALYSIS: **Census 2027 routing**: the exercise is officially scheduled, but no new migration result exists at this cutoff. Keep the 2020-21 survey figures dated and use 26_World-Population-and-Demographic-Transition.md for the schedule.

11. Mains angles

- "India's migration is not one stream but many." Discuss with reference to marriage, labour and circular migration.
- Analyse the impact of internal migration on source regions, destination cities and gender relations in India.
- Why does distress migration persist even in a high-growth economy?

12. Probable Questions

Prelims-style concept prompt

- ANALYSIS: Which of the following statements about migration in India is/are correct? (1) Interstate migrants form the dominant share of migrants in the latest official snapshot. (2) Marriage is the dominant reason for female migration in official data. **Answer:** Only statement (2) is correct, because this file notes that most migrants are intrastate, while marriage accounts for the overwhelming share of female migration.

Probable Mains questions (10-15 marks)

- ANALYSIS: Discuss why rural-rural, rural-urban and circular migration must be separated to understand India's migration geography. (15 marks)
- ANALYSIS: Critically analyse whether internal migration in India is better understood as opportunity-led mobility or distress-driven survival. (10 marks)

13. Study link

Geography -> Human Geography -> Migration in India Geography -> Human Geography -> Interstate Migration + Rural-Urban Mobility

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
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What this owner must now support

- Indentured labour export and diaspora cultural identity

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the panels as one topic-specific conceptual atlas: root question, classifications, processes or arguments, comparisons, objections and a final answer-writing spine. This text-native master is separate from both graphical flowchart artifacts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Migration concept firewall

MIGRATION -> change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary
IMMIGRATION -> movement into a country or receiving region
EMIGRATION -> movement out of a country or sending region
DATA RULE -> place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Push-pull-obstacle model

ORIGIN PUSH -> job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure
DESTINATION PULL -> wages, safety, education, amenities, networks
INTERVENING OBSTACLES -> distance, cost, borders, information gaps
SELECTIVITY -> age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Ravenstein law strip

MOST MOVES -> short distance rather than very long distance
STEP MIGRATION -> village to town to city to metropolis
COUNTER-STREAM -> each major flow generates some reverse movement
LIMIT -> use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Distance-decay and step migration

DISTANCE RISES -> cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
OPPORTUNITY NODES -> nearer towns intercept part of the flow
NETWORKS -> reduce cost and keep corridors alive
RESULT -> many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Migration stream matrix

RURAL-RURAL -> marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
RURAL-URBAN -> labour, services, education, construction
URBAN-URBAN -> professional, business and higher-education mobility
URBAN-RURAL -> return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Source-destination balance sheet

SOURCE -> reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
DESTINATION -> labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure
AGE-SEX EFFECT -> selective migration alters both ends differently
VERDICT -> migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: India official snapshot

ALL-INDIA RATE -> 28.9% in MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21
RURAL RATE -> 26.5% | URBAN RATE -> 34.9%
INTRASTATE -> 87.5% | INTERSTATE -> 12.5%
RULE -> label the source-year before using any percentage

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Marriage migration dominance

FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE -> 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
ANALYTICAL RESULT -> raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration
RURAL-RURAL STREAM -> remains large because marriage mobility is large
EXAM USE -> separate social migration from labour migration explicitly

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: India corridor map

SENDING BELTS -> Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
GAINER ZONES -> Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab
CURRENT LOGIC -> labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors
QUALIFIER -> the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Circular migration and undercount

SEASONAL MOVEMENT -> brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work
USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA -> can miss repeated short-duration mobility
POLICY EFFECT -> portability of welfare becomes a major issue
CITY EFFECT -> rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Large-city attraction logic

DIVERSE JOB SET -> big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points
NETWORKS -> earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants
TRANSPORT + SERVICES -> large nodes compress search costs
COUNTERPOINT -> some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Migration answer spine

DEFINE -> residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
EXPLAIN -> push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration
MAP -> marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India
QUALIFY -> intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing